



**МИНИСТЕРСТВО ИНОСТРАННЫХ ДЕЛ**

**ПРИВИЛЕГИРОВАННЫЕ ИНСТРУКЦИИ**

**PRIVILEGED INSTRUCTIONS**

**Ministry of Foreign Affairs  
RUSSIAN FEDERATION**



Министерство иностранных дел Российской Федерации

The Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Russian Federation

## Privileged Instructions

### Fundamental Principles

- The Arctic is a zone of peace and stability.
- Increase environmental sustainability.
- Reduce the level of threats to national security in the Arctic.
- Provide favorable international conditions for the socio-economic development of the Arctic zone of the Russian Federation.
- Development of the Northern Sea Route as a competitive national transport artery.

### Desired End States

- PRIMARY: Continued economic development of the Arctic.
- ALTERNATE: Economic development of the NSR.
- Additional details tied to end states above:
  - Promote economic utilization of the Northern Sea Route.
  - Expansion of our resource base through exploration and extraction of hydrocarbon deposits.
  - Maintain favorable military posture in the Arctic zones.

### Primary Guidance Background

- Arctic claims, under UNCLOS, are honored and adhered to. The straight baseline method of determining territorial waters is in line with UNCLOS regulations. The current NSR passes through Russian territorial waters, and as such we can legally regulate transit.
- China is a partner in the development of the Arctic resources. Our partnerships, economically and militarily, suit a greater purpose of increased economic production while maintaining security.

### Delegation Instructions

***Ensure periodic reports, requests for further guidance, or clarifications to the instructions herein are submitted via message to the office of the Foreign Minister.***

**GENERAL:** Below are our negotiation positions during this conference. Deviations from these instructions is to be conferred with the Foreign Minister prior to negotiating.

The actions we have taken in Ukraine are not a topic for this conference. We are able to compartmentalize and focus on the concerns at hand in the Arctic. Do not let other delegations focus on areas not pertinent to this conference. If they cannot compartmentalize it is not our issue.

Per our Foreign Policy Concept (in references) you should seek: peaceful resolution of international issues in accordance with UNCLOS to regulate interstate relations in the Arctic Ocean; neutralize the course of unfriendly states towards the militarization of the region and limiting our ability to exercise our sovereign rights in the Russian Arctic zone; ensure the international legal regime of our internal



maritime waters; and establish mutually beneficial cooperation with non-Arctic states pursuing a constructive policy towards Russia.

We will not negotiate bilaterally with U.S. We do not recognize their opinions to any Russian claim dispute with other Arctic states. Until they become UNCLOS signatories they have forfeited the right to arbitrate any land/sea disputes between signatory states.

China deserves a place at negotiations. As a major investor in Arctic exploration and economic development they should be involved in determining any settlement(s). As a near-Arctic partner they have shown their willingness to promote economic development and conduct scientific research to the betterment of all nations.

We no longer need to use Finland as an intermediary to the EU on Arctic issues. Their previous usefulness in conveying our diplomatic dialog with European states is not pertinent to the current development of the Arctic. We will deal directly with the other European Arctic states.

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### **Territory**

Over 50-percent of the Arctic shoreline borders are Russian territory. The Arctic ice pack has reduced significantly enough to allow greater development of Russian territorial and EEZ waters. This region has produced over 10-percent of our Gross Domestic Product and shows signs of a greater economic windfall for us.

The planting of our flag on the seabed on the North Pole demonstrates we are the only nation with the capability and capacity to develop the high Arctic. The Lomonosov Ridge has shown initial scientific evidence of its connection to Russian territory. With the CLCS validating the majority of our claims only further proves this. Any claims by Canada or Denmark should not be considered valid. A recognition of our rightful ownership to this region should be sought.

We honour the delineation of the different waters and zones defined within UNCLOS. All Arctic states are signatories, except for the U.S. Our EEZ and continental shelf claims overlap with the Canada, Denmark, and Norway. We must keep our interests on the rightful ownership of these areas governed by international law.

Our continental shelf claims overlap with the U.S. in the Eastern Special Area. This area, along with others in the Bering Sea, were negotiated by the Soviet Union in 1990. The Maritime Boundary Agreement was ratified in the U.S. Senate but has yet to be ratified by the Russian Duma. We must maintain the agreed rightful ownership of these areas but may contest them if the U.S. seeks to block other initiatives in these negotiations.

The 1920 Spitsbergen Treaty placed restrictions on the governance of the Spitsbergen Archipelago. We have honored this treaty and conducted scientific studies and coal extraction in accordance with agreed procedures. Norway's claim to establish an EEZ around Spitsbergen is in conflict with the Treaty. We do not recognize their right to establish an EEZ nor any word-play attempts to establish other economic controls surrounding Spitsbergen (such as Temporary Fisheries Protection Zone).

In respects to the NSR, we consider the route to be within our territorial waters, in accordance with UNCLOS. Any claims that this passage is an international strait erodes our sovereign rights. Our continued investment in icebreakers has opened up this route for increased trade between Asia and Europe. The need for icebreakers, search and rescue capabilities, and ways to ensure the free flow of trade all place economic burdens on us.

**Red Line:**

Not maintaining full control of the NSR as a Russian trade route.

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**Militarization**

Most of the bases that are being reopened were created and occupied during the Soviet Union times. After the collapse of the Soviet Union, we lacked the financial capacity to keep these established bases open. With our economic recovery we desire to reopen bases we left in disrepair.

The Russian armed forces provide security and safety in the Arctic. The military buildup by other foreign states in the Arctic increases the potential for conflict. The capabilities we are installing on these bases is to protect the air, land, and sea space of Russian territory.

The Vostok-18 and Zapad-21 exercises were not a threat to the balance of global powers. We were simply demonstrating the interoperability and improved capability of our modern armed forces. The inclusion of China in our military exercises is logical. The majority of our country lies in Asia. As such, working with another regional power helps foster cooperation and reduces the chance for military miscalculations between us.

When the U.S., or NATO, exercise their military are they not testing their capacity to operate and incorporate their new capabilities? The U.S. and Canada still maintain the NORAD suite of sensors to monitor the Arctic airspace. The U.S. Air Base in Thule, Greenland is a part of the sensor network designed to monitor the Arctic.

**Red Line:**

Any foreign fleet patrolling in Russian sovereign waters.

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**Resources**

Mineral and non-mineral resources within Russian waters are for Russian exploitation. Actions by foreign states and/or international organizations to obstruct Russian legitimate economic or other activities in the Arctic is illegitimate.

The Russian GDP relies on energy extraction from the Arctic. With the greatest percentage of GDP coming from Arctic resources Russia has the greatest economic interest in developing the Arctic.

Our national security is hampered by the slow pace of geological exploration for resources in the Arctic. We will enlarge exploration and investment in the development of hydrocarbon raw materials and solid mineral fields. The wealth that we can extract will ensure our economic stability and reduce the impacts of foreign governments to restrict Russian activities.

We do not recognize the so-called EEZ, or exclusive Temporary Fisheries Protection Zone, surrounding Spitsbergen. The Spitsbergen Treaty clearly states the limits of Norwegian territorial control over these islands and their surrounding waters. Russian fisherman will continue to fish these waters.

**Red Line:**

Any claims to extend exploration rights and licenses within disputed Arctic areas.

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## **Environment**

Russia has enacted environmental policies to offset a legacy of disregard in our Arctic. During the Soviet era many areas were neglected and contaminated. We have identified over 300 areas, nationally, that require extensive environmental clean-up. Many of these areas are in the Arctic and we have begun an honest effort to restore these areas by collecting and disposing of over 136-billion tons of industrial pollution.

We've developed a science-based network of specially protected natural areas, and waters, to preserve ecological systems and make them resilient to climate change ensuring preservation of the Arctic natural flora and fauna.

Our partnerships with Norway, to reduce pollution in the Barents Sea region, the U.S., to monitor threatened Arctic wildlife, and Sweden, to lower air pollution levels, have all shown our commitment to environmental issues and preservation.

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## **Governance**

Our greatest issue regarding governance in the Arctic are the attempts by several foreign states to revise basic provisions in the international treaties that govern the Arctic. Nations that establish regulatory frameworks without considering these treaties are creating a security dilemma.

We support the goodwill of Arctic organizations and will continue to strengthen them. Our active participation in the Arctic Council and the Arctic Five are testaments to this. The recent condemnation from the other Arctic Council member states regarding our operation in Ukraine is disingenuous at best. Their statement said "we remain convinced of the enduring value of the Arctic Council for circumpolar cooperation" yet their actions clearly go against this.

The resumption of Arctic Council activities that do not include us goes against the Ottawa agreement and threaten our future participation in this forum. Our chairmanship has been neutered. There still remains work to be done in the Arctic and with the other nations suspending Council business with us only halts any progress we all have made.

If the Arctic Council resumes fully, we feel that China should be included as a member state, and not as an observer. Their interest and significant investment in scientific research and economic development throughout the Arctic should afford them a seat at the table as a full member.

Conversely, we do not support the inclusion of the European Union as an observer to the Council. As an economic block that views member state's territorial waters and EEZs as 'commons' would complicate governance by the Council. Denmark and Finland can represent their own interests on the Council without Brussels' influence.

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## **Population**

We recognize the many indigenous minorities that populate our country. Our state policy is to improve the quality of life for the populations in the Arctic zone of the Federation, including indigenous minorities. No special governance nor unique political roles will be granted to indigenous groups. They are, and will be, treated as Russians and will enjoy all the privileges that come with that.